Prioritisation Models

Every model prices one line of the bill for the wrong order. Know which line, and what it can't see.

THE BILL FOR THE WRONG ORDER

LINE 1 · CAPACITY
The slot you spend

MoSCoW protects it

LINE 2 · VALUE
The value you misjudge

RICE, ICE, value vs effort, weighted scoring price it

LINE 3 · TIME
The weeks it waits

Cost of Delay, CD3, WSJF price it

Models disagree because **they put different lines on top**. Read each one for what it can see.

VALUE FOR EFFORT · LINE 2

RICE INTERCOM

Reach × Impact × Confidence ÷ Effort

→ reach varies a lot

Confidence follows evidence: **100 / 80 / 50%**

⚠ **no column for time**

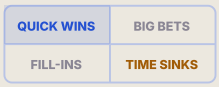
ICE SEAN ELLIS

Impact × Confidence × Ease

→ triaging small experiments

⚠ **three unanchored guesses**

Value vs effort



→ sorting a long list fast

⚠ **no axis for a date**

Weighted scoring

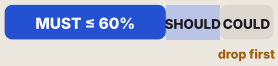
Σ weight × score

→ leadership must see trade-offs

⚠ **weights changed after scoring**

SCOPE AND TIME · LINES 1 AND 3

MoSCoW CLEGG · DSDM



→ scoping a fixed timebox

Must = no point, not legal, unsafe or not viable without it. **Won't = this time.**

⚠ **it doesn't rank**

Cost of Delay REINERTSEN



→ pricing the weeks, as a range

⚠ **untested ideas get huge ranges**

CD3

Cost of Delay ÷ Duration

→ ordering by urgency

⚠ **a deadline item scores zero today**

WSJF SAFE

(Value + Time criticality + Risk) ÷ Job size

→ many teams, relative sizing

⚠ **added columns hide argument**

THREE RULES

Put fixed dates on the calendar first.

Score with one unit, one anchor, one evidence rule.

In the room, bring the inputs, not the score.

WHEN THESE MISLEAD YOU

A precise score: decimals don't make a guess accurate

Gamed RICE: mixed units, inflated impact, fudged confidence

Scores across teams: not on the same scale

One model for everything: each is blind to a line of the bill

A score you can't explain is a score you can't defend.

Sources: Intercom, McBride (2018); ProductPlan, ICE; Agile Business Consortium, DSDM MoSCoW; Black Swan Farming, Cost of Delay; Scaled Agile, WSJF.